THE SOLLARAN ARCHONATE

# THE ATLAS OF SOLLARA

## A PLAYER'S HANDBOOK



*Being a true and faithful guide to the Book of Maps, the Market, the Party's Loot, and all else that the Adventurer may find therein.*

FOR THE USE OF THE PARTY · KEEP IT DRY

BEFORE THE JOURNEY

# A WORD TO THE ADVENTURER

Hearken, traveller. The Archonate of Sollara is wide, and no one walks it well without a map. Your Dungeon Master keeps a living atlas for this campaign: maps of the continent and its dukedoms, the town of Emmett, the inns and temples within it, and everything your party has learned along the way. It also holds the markets where you may buy and sell, and the stash where your treasure is kept.

This handbook explains every part of it, in the order you are likely to need it. The atlas is for the *party*: what you write and buy is seen by your companions, and what your Dungeon Master hides stays hidden until the story reveals it.


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### THE ADVENTURER'S NOTE

This handbook covers what a *player* sees. Your Dungeon Master has further tools that are not described here, and the pages may change a little as the campaign grows. When in doubt, ask.

CHAPTER I

# FIRST STEPS

*"Know the door before you knock upon it."*

The atlas lives on the web, so there is nothing to install. Open the address your Dungeon Master gave you in any browser, on a computer, a tablet or a phone. It is the same book on every device, and what one of you adds appears on everyone's screen within moments.

## SIGNING IN

1. You will meet a gate. Press the button to SIGN IN WITH GOOGLE.
2. Choose the Google account your Dungeon Master knows you by. There are no other passwords and no new accounts to make.
3. The book opens. Your first name now sits on the button at the top right. Press it only when you wish to SIGN OUT.

The atlas can be limited to the people your Dungeon Master names. If the gate turns you away, tell them which Google address you used.

## TELLING THE ATLAS WHO YOU ARE

The first time you write a note, the atlas asks for your NAME OR CHARACTER. It remembers it afterward, and a small *change* link lets you alter it. This is the name your companions see beside your notes and your purchases.

## ON A PHONE OR TABLET

Everything works by touch. Panels rise from the bottom of the screen and close with the ×. Documents turn with a swipe; maps are dragged with a finger and zoomed with a pinch.

> **THE ADVENTURER'S NOTE**
> After your Dungeon Master updates the atlas, your browser may show the old pages for about ten minutes. Hold CTRL and press F5 (on a phone, reload twice) to fetch the new ones.

CHAPTER II

# THE BOOK OF MAPS

The atlas is a book. Each page is either a MAP or a DOCUMENT, and the page's name appears beneath the title at the top. Turn the pages with the arrows at either edge, the folded corners, the ← and → keys, or a swipe across a document.

## THE BAR OF ICONS

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| ☰ | CONTENTS | Every page in the book, nested as the world is. A dukedom opens into its towns, a town into its inns. Press the small arrows to open or close a branch, or a name to go there. |
| 🔍 | SEARCH | Find any place, page or scrap of lore. Press / from anywhere, then use the arrow keys and ENTER. |
| 👥 | PEOPLE | The register of everyone your party knows (Chapter VI). |
| 🛡 | RENOWN | How the party is regarded in each place (Chapter VII). |
| 💰 | MARKET | Shops, loot, trade and the Consortium (Chapters VIII to XIII). |
| ◎ | PING | Point out a spot to the whole party (Chapter V). |
| 🔥 | TORCHLIGHT | Darkens the map, for night scenes (Chapter V). |
| 📜 | ABOUT | Notes on the current page, and the party notes written beneath them. |

## READING A MAP

- DRAG to pan, and use the wheel or a pinch to ZOOM. The compass rose in the corner shows north.
- Small marks on the map are PINS: towns, inns, temples and the like (Chapter III).
- A gold link in a document jumps to the place or person it names.
- The page number at the foot is the *folio*. ESC closes whatever is open on top of the book.

CHAPTER III

# PLACES AND PINS

*"Every pin is a door. Open it."*

Press any pin on a map and a panel opens beside it. Press a town and you will find, in order, whatever your party has learned of it.

## WHAT A PLACE MAY HOLD

- A description and sometimes a picture.
- The party's standing there, for towns and cities (Chapter VII).
- People here: those who may be found at this place, each a link to their entry.
- Shops here: the merchants and craftsmen of the place, each a link to its stock.
- Party notes: what you and your companions have written (Chapter IV).

## THE ABOUT TAB

Every page has an About panel, opened by the book icon in the bar (or the tab at the edge of the map). It tells what the whole page is: the lore of a dukedom, the history of a city. It also holds the party notes for that page.

## PLACES INSIDE PLACES

The Archonate is built of nested maps. A dukedom's map shows its towns; a town such as Emmett has its own map; and within it stand inns and chapels, each with floors of their own. Use the Contents, or press a pin that leads onward, to go deeper.

> **THE ADVENTURER'S NOTE**
> Not everything is shown to you at once. Your Dungeon Master reveals pins, people and shops as your party discovers them, so a place may appear that was not on the map yesterday.

CHAPTER IV

# YOUR NOTES

Beneath every pin, page, person and shop is a place for PARTY NOTES. Write rumors you have heard, suspicions you hold, debts you are owed, or the name of the innkeeper who overcharged you. It is the party's shared memory, and it is saved at once.

## WRITING A NOTE

1. Open the thing you wish to write about and find *Party notes* at the bottom of its panel.
2. Type in the box. Press ADD NOTE, or CTRL + ENTER.
3. Your note appears under your name, for everyone in the party to read.

## PRIVATE NOTES

Tick PRIVATE before you add a note and only *you* will see it, not your companions, and not your Dungeon Master. Use it for a character's secret, a plan you are not ready to share, or a reminder to yourself.

## CHANGING YOUR MIND

You can edit or delete your own notes. You cannot alter anyone else's.

> **THE ADVENTURER'S NOTE**
> A note belongs to the thing you wrote it under. A rumor about the Duke goes under the Duke, and a warning about a bridge goes under the bridge. File it where you will think to look for it.

> **BEWARE**
> A shared note is read by the whole table. If your character is keeping a secret from the party, tick PRIVATE.

CHAPTER V

# PING AND TORCHLIGHT

Two small tools make the map a table-top companion. Both appear only when a map is open.

## PING: "LOOK HERE!"

Press the Ping icon, then press a spot on the map, or simply right-click the spot. A pulsing ring appears on every party member's map, with your name beside it, and fades after a few seconds. Anyone looking at a different page is offered a Go there button. Use it to say *we are here*, *the ambush is there*, or *this is the bridge I mean*. Press Esc to leave ping mode.

## TORCHLIGHT

Press the Torchlight icon and the map grows dark, with a circle of light that follows your pointer or finger. It is for mood alone, ideal when the party is in a cellar, a cave or a crypt. Press the icon again to bring back the day.

> **THE ADVENTURER'S NOTE**
> Both tools change only *your* screen or send a brief signal. They never alter the map itself.

CHAPTER VI

# THE PEOPLE OF THE REALM

Press the People icon to open the *Dramatis Personae*: everyone your party has met or heard of, with their portraits, titles and descriptions.

## GROUPS WITHIN GROUPS

People are sorted into groups, and groups sit inside one another. *Emmett* may hold *The Roosting Crow*, which holds its staff, and *the Chapel of the Rising Sun*, which holds its Sisters. Press a group's name to open or close it. The number beside it counts everyone inside. A group may also carry a renown standing of its own (Chapter VII).

## FINDING SOMEONE

- Type in the search box to match names, titles, groups and places. Every group holding a match opens by itself.
- Press a name to read their entry: a portrait, a description, and the places where they may be found, each a link.
- An entry also holds the party notes about that person (Chapter IV).

## SHOPKEEPERS

When a shop has a named proprietor, their entry appears here too, filed under the town's *Merchants*. The shop page links to them, and they link back.

> **THE ADVENTURER'S NOTE**
> You see only the people your Dungeon Master has made known to you. A character you have not yet met is not in the register, and a name may appear there before you have learned all of their story.

CHAPTER VII

# RENOWN

*"A good name is a coin that cannot be stolen, only spent."*

Renown is the PARTY'S standing with a place or a group, shared by all of you together. It is a number from −10 to +10, which falls into a named tier. Press the RENOWN icon to see where you stand, and press any entry to read its *history*, with the reason for every change.

| TIER | FROM | WHAT IT MEANS (A GENERAL GUIDE) |
|---|---|---|
| REVILED | −10 | Guards may arrest you on sight; no one will trade with you. |
| DISTRUSTED | −6 | Higher prices, closed doors, and the Watch keeps an eye on you. |
| DISLIKED | −2 | Cool service and the worse price; never the benefit of the doubt. |
| UNKNOWN | 0 | Nobody knows you. Ordinary prices, ordinary treatment. |
| RESPECTED | +3 | Locals share rumors and lend a hand. |
| HONORED | +7 | Discounts, free lodging, and an audience with local leaders. |
| EXALTED | +10 | Heroes here. People take real risks for you. |

## WHAT RENOWN DOES IN THE MARKET

Each shop shows *your standing* and how it changes the shop's terms. Good renown lowers prices, up to a quarter off at +10, and opens the doors to better goods. Poor renown raises them (up to 60% more at −10) and holds the better goods back. Below −6, a merchant will not deal with you at all.

### THE ADVENTURER'S NOTE

Renown is earned and lost by what the party *does*. Your Dungeon Master sets each number and writes the reason into the history. Each place keeps its own tally, so a great name in Emmett means little in the next dukedom. Tiers and wording may differ a little in your game, and a place may hold its own specifics.

CHAPTER VIII

# THE MARKET

Press the Market icon (the coin purse) to open three tabs: Shops, Loot and My purchases. Shops are grouped by the place where they stand. Press one to enter it.

## INSIDE A SHOP

- The proprietor and a word about the shop, and a line showing your standing and how it affects prices.
- The local market: what is cheap and what is dear in this town (Chapter XII).
- The stock: each item, how many are left, its price, and a Buy button. A price struck through means it has been adjusted for you.
- A countdown: *stock refreshes in so many days*. Shelves are restocked each week.

## KINDS OF GOODS

| | |
|---|---|
| Plain | Everyday goods at everyday quality. |
| Fine | A better-made version, at double the price. Bigger towns have more of them. |
| Under the counter | Rare or special goods, offered only to customers in good standing. Otherwise you will read *not for you, not yet*. |
| House special | A thing this shop is known for. |
| Service | Lodging, healing, repairs and the like. It never runs out. |

## BUYING

1. Press Buy, enter how many, and confirm.
2. The purchase is written to the ledger, and the goods are placed in the party's Loot (Chapter XI).
3. You settle the gold with your Dungeon Master at the table. My purchases lists everything you bought and whether it has been settled.

### THE ADVENTURER'S NOTE

A larger settlement stocks more, finer goods and more rarities. A hamlet may have a handful of wares; a city has many. Shops of the same kind in different towns will not offer the same things.

CHAPTER IX

# HAGGLING

Every shop lets you HAGGLE ONCE A WEEK. Press the HAGGLE button and the atlas rolls a twenty-sided die for you, adds your character's PERSUASION BONUS, and reads the result against the table below. There is nothing to type and nothing to dispute: the die is cast in the atlas.

| TOTAL | THE MERCHANT'S ANSWER | PRICES |
|---|---|---|
| 5 OR LESS | Offended! | +20% |
| 6 TO 9 | Unimpressed. | +10% |
| 10 TO 14 | No deal. | no change |
| 15 TO 19 | A fair bargain. | −10% |
| 20 TO 24 | Charmed. | −15% |
| 25 OR MORE | Won over completely. | −20% |

## YOUR PERSUASION BONUS

The first time you haggle, the atlas asks for your character's Persuasion bonus (such as +3, or −1). Enter it *once*. After that your Dungeon Master keeps it up to date as you level, so you will not be asked again.

## HOW IT WORKS

- The result applies to EVERYTHING YOU BUY AT THAT SHOP until its stock refreshes, and also WHEN YOU SELL THERE, in your favor if you rolled well (Chapter XII).
- You may haggle *once per shop, per week*. A different shop is a fresh attempt.
- Your companions haggle for themselves; one person's luck is not shared.

> **BEWARE**
> A poor roll makes things *dearer*, not merely the same. Consider carefully whether to risk it before a big purchase. If a roll goes badly wrong, your Dungeon Master can reset it, but ask nicely.

> **THE ADVENTURER'S NOTE**
> Black markets keep their own counsel. They favor the people the law dislikes, so the *worse* your standing with the authorities, the better they treat you.

CHAPTER X

# THE SMITH'S REPAIRS

In the Archonate, every weapon and every piece of armor has three damage slots. When all three are spent, the item is broken and will not serve until mended. A blacksmith will repair it for gold, and the atlas works out the price for you.

## USING THE REPAIR PANEL

Open a Blacksmith & Armorer and find *Repairs* above the stock.

1. Choose Weapon or Armor or shield.
2. Choose the item's rarity. Look the item up on D&D Beyond to find it. A plain sword is *Common*; a +1 weapon is *Uncommon*, and so on up the ladder.
3. Say how many slots are used: one, two, or three (broken).
4. Optionally name the item, so the ledger shows which it was.
5. Read the price, then press Pay for the repair. The mending is instant.

| Rarity | 1 slot | 2 slots | Broken | Smith needed |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Common | 2 gp | 4½ gp | 9 gp | Any village; a hamlet, if not broken |
| Uncommon | 25 gp | 56 gp | 113 gp | A town or larger |
| Rare | 150 gp | 338 gp | 675 gp | A city or larger |
| Very rare | 800 gp | 1,800 gp | 3,600 gp | A metropolis |
| Legendary | | Beyond any ordinary smith | | A master, or a quest |

Prices shown here are before your renown and haggling, which adjust them as they do any purchase. Each further slot costs a little more than the last, and a fully broken piece costs a little extra to rebuild.

> **THE ADVENTURER'S NOTE**
> If a smith cannot work on your item, the panel says so and names the size of town to look for. That is a hint about where to travel next. You may also restore slots yourself by resting, by the rules your Dungeon Master gave you.

CHAPTER XI

# THE PARTY'S LOOT

Everything the party finds or buys is kept in one shared stash, under the Loot tab of the Market. Anyone in the party may look into it at any time.

## WHAT THE TAB SHOWS

- The party purse at the top: the coins held in common. Your Dungeon Master adds and divides them.
- In the party's Loot: each item with its quantity and value, where it was found, and, for goods you bought, what was paid for it.
- Claimed: items a character has taken. These belong to that character now.
- History: a running record of finds, claims, sales and identifications.

## TAKING AN ITEM

When a character wants to keep something from the stash, tell your Dungeon Master, who will give it to your character. It leaves the shared Loot and goes into the Claimed list under your name.

## UNIDENTIFIED MAGIC

A magic item the party has found is not what it seems. You will see only what a character could see at a glance: *a crystal set in a plain pendant*, perhaps, with its value marked *unknown*. To learn what it truly is:

1. Visit a shop that offers Identify an item (Arcane Curios and temples do, for about 20 gp).
2. Press Buy on that service, choose which unidentified item to study, and confirm.
3. The sage takes it away. The item is revealed automatically the next time your Dungeon Master opens the atlas, and its real name and powers replace the vague description.

> **THE ADVENTURER'S NOTE**
> You may not identify an item without paying for it. This is by design: magic in the Archonate is a puzzle, and the sage's fee is part of the price of knowing.

CHAPTER XII

# THE MERCHANT'S ROAD

*"Buy where it is made, and sell where it is wanted."*

Each town has its own market. What is cheap in one place is dear in another, so a patient trader may earn a little by carrying goods across the land. The atlas keeps count of all of it.

## READING A TOWN'S MARKET

A shop's page carries a line such as *"In this market:* CHEAP *wine, salt;* DEAR *silk, spices."* Ten kinds of goods vary from town to town: wine and spirits, ale and mead, salt, spices, coffee, tea and perfume, silk and fine cloth, gems and jewelry, furs and leather, iron and ingots, and grain. Lynport is famed for its wine; Saltyard for its salt; the capital craves luxuries.

## SELLING YOUR GOODS

1. Open the Loot tab. Goods you bought are listed there.
2. Press SELL... beside an item that is not yet claimed.
3. Choose a shop. The list shows what each will pay; merchants who sell that kind of goods pay the most.
4. Read the offer. The atlas shows how it was reached, and whether it is a PROFIT or a LOSS on what was paid.
5. Press Sell it.

The gold is OWED TO YOU: it appears under *My sales* in the ledger, and your Dungeon Master pays you at the table.

## WHAT SHAPES THE PRICE

The item's standard value, what that shop pays for such goods (a merchant of the right trade gives about 85%), how much the town WANTS it, the party's RENOWN there, and your HAGGLE (a good roll now earns you *more*).

> **BEWARE**
> Selling at the town where you bought almost always loses money. The profit is on the road. Shops also have limits: each can pay only so much in ONE SALE and in ONE WEEK (see the tables), so a small town cannot buy a dragon's hoard. Plan your route, and your Dungeon Master may have plans for you on it.

> **THE ADVENTURER'S NOTE**
> Example. Fine wine is cheap in Lynport, where you pay 7 gp a bottle. In Saltyard, where it is wanted, a wine merchant may pay 11 gp. Five bottles earn about 20 gp, which is not a fortune, but the wine had to be carried there.

CHAPTER XIII

# THE GRAND EXCHANGE CONSORTIUM

*"Gold is heavy. Paper is not."*

The G.E.C. keeps a branch in the great cities, and its marble counters offer four services. Whatever you open or buy there is YOURS ALONE. Where coins change hands, it goes on the ledger and you settle with your Dungeon Master at the table.

## CHANGING COINS

One gold is ten silver, which is a hundred copper. The Consortium changes any coin for any other and keeps 5 COPPER each time, so 1 gp becomes 9 sp 5 cp. Choose the coins and the amount, and the atlas shows what you will receive.

## WRITS OF EXCHANGE

Pay the Consortium and it writes you a paper, good at ANY BRANCH IN ANOTHER CITY, so you need not carry the gold. The fee is 5%: a writ for 200 gp costs 210 gp. The writ goes into the party's Loot. To cash one, open a branch in a different city and choose CASH IT HERE; the amount is owed to you, and the paper is used up. A writ pays *whoever holds it*, so guard it.

## SAVINGS ACCOUNTS

Open an account at a branch, then deposit and withdraw gold as you please. It earns 3% INTEREST EVERY 30 DAYS, and the atlas keeps the count in real time. An account works ONLY AT THE BRANCH THAT HOLDS IT, in the city where you opened it.

## SAFETY-DEPOSIT BOXES

With an account open, you may rent a box. The rent is taken from the account each month, the first month at once. Each item you store is small, medium or large, and the box has room for only so much:

| BOX | RENT A MONTH | IT HOLDS, AT MOST |
|---|---|---|
| SMALL | 5 GP | 4 small items, or 2 medium, or 1 large |
| MEDIUM | 10 GP | 8 small items, or 4 medium, or 2 large |
| LARGE | 20 GP | 16 small items, or 8 medium, or 4 large |

*Small* is a potion, ring or pouch of gems; *medium* a dagger, book or lantern; *large* a longsword, shield or armor. Move goods in from the party's Loot, or list your own things. If the account cannot pay the rent, the box is LOCKED: nothing goes in or out until you top up the account and pay what is owed. Your things stay safe.

CHAPTER XIV

# FESTIVALS

The Archonate keeps two great holidays. When your Dungeon Master declares one under way, a BANNER appears at the top of the atlas, a short note greets you in the Market, and the shops fill with festival goods. Press the banner to go to the Market.

## THE FESTIVAL OF THE SACRED HARMONY

Held once a year, on the seventh hour of the seventh day of the seventh month, when the Sanguine Sisters carry their crystals to the capital and the Song is heard across the land. Pilgrims crowd the roads. Look for white-and-gold ribbons and candles, pilgrim's rations, song-purified water, white festival robes, hymnals, blessings for the road, and, for those in good standing, a rare crystal-song shard at the temples.

## BERTRAM'S RYE ALE FESTIVAL

Held six months later: a raucous, joyful contest in which brewers from across Sollara compete to be named *Bertram* for a year. Look for commemorative tankards, tasting flights of rye ale, entry kegs, rye mash, festival feasts at the inns, and, for trusted customers, this year's winning keg.

## THE RULES OF FESTIVAL GOODS

- Festival goods are marked as HARMONY SPECIALS or FESTIVAL SPECIALS, and sit beside the usual stock.
- Rare specials are held back for customers in good standing, as with any under-the-counter goods.
- They are bought and carried like anything else, and they can be sold on.
- When the festival ends, the specials are gone. BLACK MARKETS TAKE NO PART in either holiday.

> **THE ADVENTURER'S NOTE**
> Festivals pass. If something tempts you, buy it while the banner flies.

CHAPTER XV

# TROUBLE AND REMEDIES

Should something go awry, begin here.

| THE TROUBLE | THE REMEDY |
|---|---|
| The page is blank, or looks as it did last week. | Hold Ctrl and press F5. After an update the old copy may linger for about ten minutes. On a phone, reload twice. |
| The gate will not let me in. | Use the Google address your Dungeon Master knows. If a pop-up window was blocked, allow it and try again. |
| I see "Missing or insufficient permissions." | The atlas's rules need updating. Tell your Dungeon Master; nothing you did is wrong. |
| A shop, person or place is missing. | It may be hidden until your party discovers it. Ask. |
| I cannot haggle again. | One try per shop each week. A new week, or a new shop, is a fresh attempt. Your Dungeon Master can reset one. |
| The shelves look different today. | Stock refreshes weekly, and festivals add and remove specials. |
| I bought something and cannot find it. | Look in the Market's Loot tab. Goods go to the party stash. Services (repairs, identifying) leave nothing to find. |
| I cannot sell an item. | Only unclaimed goods that the party bought may be sold by players. Found treasure is sold by your Dungeon Master, and a claimed item belongs to its character. |
| Nobody will buy my goods. | Some shops want only what they sell themselves. Try a general store or an importer, or travel to a town that wants them. |
| My safety-deposit box is locked. | The savings account could not pay the rent. Deposit gold into the account, then press Pay what is owed on the box. Nothing stored is lost. |
| I cannot cash my writ. | A writ is cashed at a Consortium branch in a *different* city from the one that issued it, and only once. |
| My savings account is not at this branch. | Accounts and boxes belong to one branch. Return to the city where you opened them. |
| My note vanished. | Private notes show only to their author, so check that you are signed in under the same account. |

### THE ADVENTURER'S NOTE

Whatever is not in this handbook, your Dungeon Master will gladly explain. The atlas is theirs to shape.

APPENDIX

# TABLES FOR QUICK REFERENCE

## SETTLEMENTS AND WHAT THEY OFFER

| SIZE | WARES | FINE GOODS | UNDER THE COUNTER | SMITH REPAIRS UP TO | ONE SALE UP TO | A WEEK UP TO |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Hamlet | 4–6 | none | none | Common (not broken) | 75 gp | 150 gp |
| Village | 6–9 | few | none | Common | 300 gp | 600 gp |
| Town | 9–12 | some | 1 | Uncommon | 1,500 gp | 3,000 gp |
| City | 12–16 | plenty | 2 | Rare | 8,000 gp | 16,000 gp |
| Metropolis | 15–20 | many | 3 | Very rare | 50,000 gp | 100,000 gp |

## RENOWN AND PRICES

| STANDING | EFFECT |
|---|---|
| +10 | 25% off |
| +5 | About 12% off |
| +3 or more | Under-the-counter goods open |
| 0 to +2 | Fine goods, ordinary prices |
| −1 and below | Dearer; better goods held back |
| −10 | 60% dearer |
| −7 and below | The merchant will not deal |

## KEYS AND SHORTCUTS

| | |
|---|---|
| / | Search |
| Ctrl + K | Search |
| ← → | Turn the page |
| Esc | Close a panel, or leave ping |
| Ctrl + Enter | Add the note |
| Right-click | Ping the map |
| Ctrl + F5 | Fetch the newest pages |

*May your purse be heavy, your blade unbroken, and your name well spoken.*